

RRB NTPC Advanced Practice Paper

Ancient Indian History — Comprehensive Syllabus Set 1 (10 High-Yield Questions)

1. Match the Indus Valley Civilisation sites with their unique archaeological signatures:

I. Bhirrana II. Dholavira III. Daimabad IV. Kunal

A. Large bronze chariot with animals

B. Earliest cultural levels of Hakra Ware and red pottery

C. Large hoard of silver crowns

D. Multi-tiered stadium and signboard with ten large characters

Choose the correct combination:

A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

B) I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B

C) I-B, II-A, III-D, IV-C

D) I-D, II-B, III-C, IV-A

Correct Answer: A) I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C

Detailed Explanation: Bhirrana (Haryana) shows the earliest Hakra ware levels. Dholavira features the unique stadium and inscription signboard. Daimabad is famous for its massive Late Harappan bronze hoard including a chariot. Kunal yielded a rare cache of silver crowns.

2. In the framework of Vedic sacrifices and philosophy, who among the following priest classes was explicitly responsible for correcting structural errors in the chanting and rituals by silent meditation and using the Atharvaveda?

A) Hotri

B) Adhvaryu

C) Udgatri

D) Brahma

Correct Answer: D) Brahma

Detailed Explanation: The Brahma priest was the supervisor of the entire sacrifice. While the Hotri recited Rigvedic hymns, the Adhvaryu performed manual steps (Yajurveda), and the Udgatri sang (Samaveda), the Brahma guarded the ritual against errors using the Atharvaveda.

3. The early Buddhist text 'Mahavamsa' details Sri Lankan dynastic chronicles. Which Mauryan dynamic official or royal family member accompanied Sanghamitta to Sri Lanka carrying a branch of the sacred Bodhi tree?

- A) Kunala
- B) Mahinda
- C) Jalauka
- D) Dasharatha

Correct Answer: B) Mahinda

Detailed Explanation: Emperor Ashoka sent his son Mahinda and later his daughter Sanghamitta to propagate Buddhism in Sri Lanka (Tamraparni) during the reign of King Devanampiya Tissa.

4. The dynamic Heliodorus Pillar inscription at Vidisha (Besnagar) is dedicated to Vasudeva (Vishnu). Heliodorus was a Greek ambassador sent by King Antialcidas to the court of which local Shunga monarch?

- A) Pushyamitra Shunga
- B) Agnimitra
- C) Bhagabhadra
- D) Devabhuti

Correct Answer: C) Bhagabhadra

Detailed Explanation: Heliodorus describes himself as a 'Bhagavata' on the monolithic column. He was sent to the court of King Bhagabhadra, the fifth Shunga ruler, proving early foreign integration into Vaishnavism.

5. In the highly centralized Gupta provincial administration, the council of local experts that directly aided the District Governor (Vishayapati) was known as the 'Vishayamahattaras'. Who among the following acted as the chief of the artisan community on this council?

- A) Prathama-Kulika
- B) Nagara-Shreshthin
- C) Sarthavaha
- D) Prathama-Kayastha

Correct Answer: A) Prathama-Kulika

Detailed Explanation: The district council included the Nagara-Shreshthin (chief merchant), Sarthavaha (caravan leader), Prathama-Kulika (chief artisan), and Prathama-Kayastha (chief scribe).

6. The unique structural composition 'Aihole Inscription' of Pulakeshin II mentions his victory over Harshavardhana. Which specific administrative title did Harsha bear that means 'Lord of the Entire North' according to contemporary southern records?

- A) Samrat
- B) Sakalauttarapathanatha
- C) Chakravartin
- D) Paramabhattacharak

Correct Answer: B) Sakalauttarapathanatha

Detailed Explanation: Chalukya records refer to Harsha as 'Sakalauttarapathanatha' (Lord of all the North), adding weight to Pulakeshin II's military achievement in stopping his southern advance.

7. The early Sangam text 'Silappadikaram' centers around Kovalan and Kannagi. Who is recorded as the royal author of its sister-epic 'Manimegalai', which offers deep philosophical insights into Buddhism?

- A) Ilango Adigal
- B) Shattanar
- C) Sitalai Sattanar
- D) Tolkappiyar

Correct Answer: C) Sitalai Sattanar

Detailed Explanation: Manimegalai was composed by Sitalai Sattanar (or Shattanar), a grain merchant of Madurai. Ilango Adigal wrote Silappadikaram.

8. Which of the following historical pairs of ancient philosophical systems (Shad-Darshana) and their foundational authors is matched incorrectly?

- A) Nyaya - Gautama
- B) Vaisheshika - Kanada
- C) Sankhya - Kapila
- D) Mimamsa - Badarayana

Correct Answer: D) Mimamsa - Badarayana

Detailed Explanation: Purva Mimamsa was founded by Jaimini. Badarayana founded Uttara Mimamsa or Vedanta. The other pairs are fully correct.

9. In the context of ancient maritime trade, the classic Western text 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea' identifies a port named 'Poduca'. Which archaeological site near modern Puducherry does this correspond to?

- A) Arikamedu
- B) Puhar
- C) Muziris
- D) Korkai

Correct Answer: A) Arikamedu

Detailed Explanation: Poduca was the classical name for Arikamedu, an Indo-Roman trading hub where significant Roman pottery, amphorae, and beads were excavated.

10. In the Mauryan judiciary described by Kautilya, the criminal courts tasked with removing anti-social elements and settling administrative friction were explicitly classified as:

- A) Dharmasthiya
- B) Kantakashodhana
- C) Mahamatrakarta
- D) Rajuka

Correct Answer: B) Kantakashodhana

Detailed Explanation: Mauryan law categorized courts into Dharmasthiya (civil courts dealing with contracts/marriage) and Kantakashodhana (criminal courts / 'removal of thorns').